Downtime – Work · SRD 5.1 / 5.2.1

A character can **work** between adventures to **fund their lifestyle**. A trade lets them live at the **Modest** level for free. A job in an organization grants the **Comfortable** level, and a **Performance** grants the **Wealthy** level.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. A trade: **Modest** lifestyle for free.
2. An organization: **Comfortable** level.
3. **Performance**: **Wealthy** level.
4. Downtime means time **off adventure**.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the lifestyle logic; this sheet reuses SRD 5.1 for the details: to be checked.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how much a job earns. Fix: a job covers lifestyle, not a money gain.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the shop, tavern or stage where the character works.

Step 1 – Choose:

A trade (smith, scribe, healer…), an organization or a Performance.

Step 2 – Duration:

At least a week or a month of work.

Step 3 – Lifestyle:

Modest free for a trade, Comfortable in an organization, Wealthy for a Performance.

Step 4 – Expenses:

No living cost for the period; no extra gain.

Step 5 – Encounters:

The DM can add contacts, rumors or trouble.

Example: Ilsa plays the harp at the tavern for a month: she lives comfortably for free.

Lifestyle	Cost per day
Wretched	Free
Squalid	1 SP
Poor	2 SP
Modest	1 GP
Comfortable	2 GP
Wealthy	4 GP
Aristocratic	10 GP

⚠ Common questions:

What does work cover?

Lifestyle, not income.

Which level for a trade?

Modest.

And an organization?

Comfortable.

And a Performance?

Wealthy.

How much does a trade earn?

Nothing extra; it avoids costs.

Can I work while traveling?

No, it's downtime.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Wages

Does a job pay? **Option**: +1 GP per day.

Skill check

Does a check change the level? **Option**: yes, +1 level on success.

Dangerous work

A risky trade. **Option**: a Con DC 10 save.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Lifestyle

It determines the period's costs.

Performance

It assumes an audience and talent.

SRD 5.1

Rule from SRD 5.1 (2014).

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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